PRODUCT STRATEGY

From Vision → Strategy → Choices → Roadmap

Circles of Strategy

From purpose to execution — aligned, focused, and impactful

Guides everything
- Purpose & impact
- Long-term aspiration
- Enduring, rarely changes

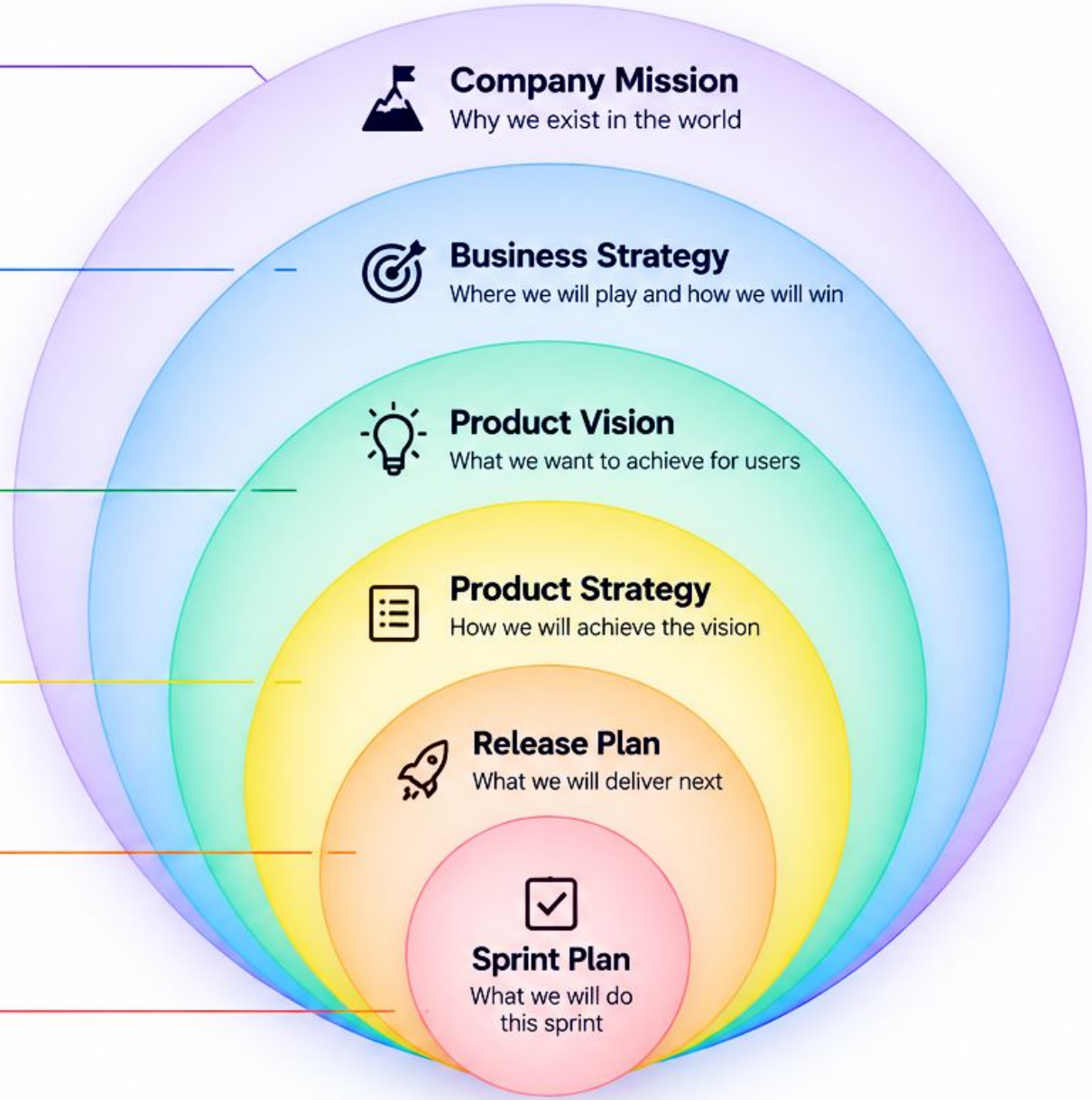
Sets the direction
- Target markets
- Business model
- Growth and competitive advantage

Inspires the product
- Long-term user outcome
- North star for the product
- Clear and compelling

Turns vision into plan
- Target users & use cases
- Value proposition
- Key bets and trade-offs

Plans the delivery
- Features and scope
- Dependencies
- Timeline and milestones

Executes the plan
- Tasks and stories
- Owner and priority
- Measurable outcomes



Executive Team
Sets purpose, direction and long-term bets

PM Vacuum
Product Management owns this space

Development Team
Turns strategy into working products

Today's challenge

You are CRED's product leadership team.

CRED has a strong position today.
Your job: decide what it should become next.

CEO QUESTION

“What should CRED become next?”

PAYMENTS

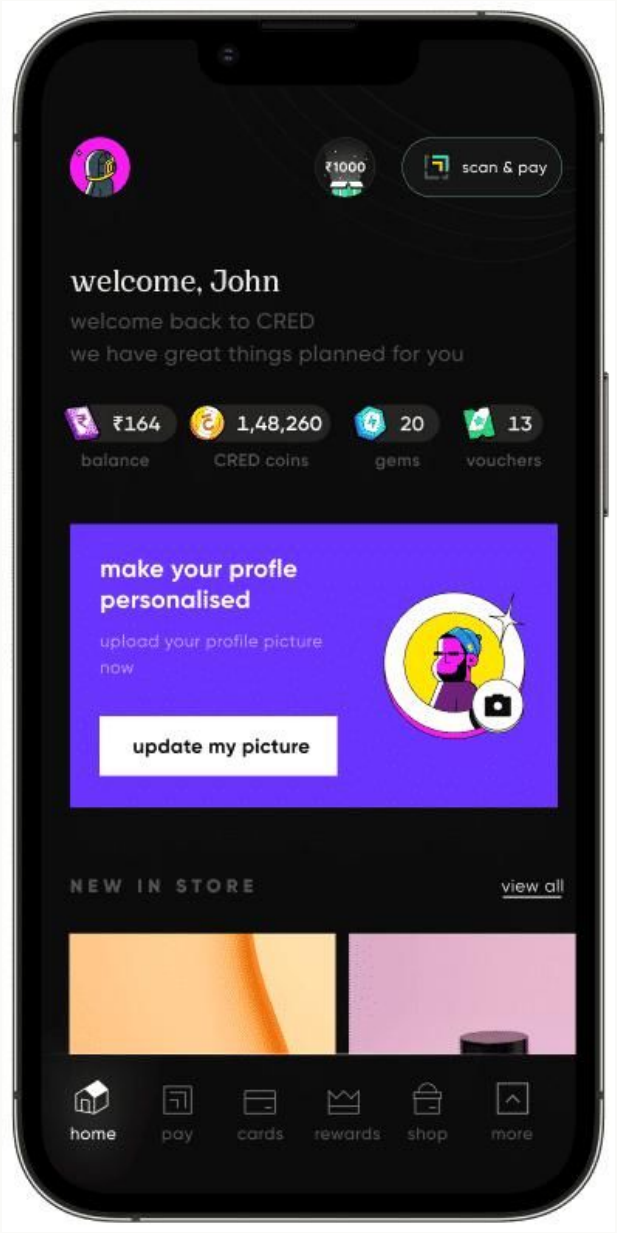
Credit-card bills + UPI

BEYOND

Lending + financial services

MEMBERSHIP

Premium / creditworthy users



What is Product Strategy?

If I give you ₹100 crore and 500 engineers, what should CRED build?

AI

BANK

WEALTH

REWARDS

Most answers jump to WHAT Strategy asks:

WHY THIS? **WHY NOW?** **WHY US?**

CONCEPT

Strategy ≠ Roadmap

The roadmap is downstream of the strategy.

STRATEGY

How will we win?

Where to play
How to win
What to prioritize
What NOT to do

ROADMAP

What will we do?

Themes
Initiatives
Sequencing
Time horizons

EXECUTION

How will we build it?

Epics
Stories
Tasks
Daily work

If you jump from Vision → Features, you skipped Strategy.

Become the trusted platform for India's creditworthy consumers by turning CRED's trust, data, and membership into personalized intelligence, action, and rewards

Where to play

Creditworthy, affluent Indian consumers who actively manage their finances.

Problem to own

Financial management is fragmented, reactive, and difficult. People can pay, borrow, invest, insure, and spend across many platforms, but lack one trusted place to understand and improve their financial health.

How CRED wins

Turn CRED's existing trust + financial data + membership into personalized financial intelligence and actions.

Strategic bets

1. **Financial Intelligence** → AI financial coach + unified financial health
2. **Financial Growth** → wealth, credit improvement, personalized financial products
3. **Premium Financial Lifestyle** → rewards, experiences

Trade-off - Don't become another everything-finance app.

ACTIVITY

ACTIVITY 1 • Fix CRED's Strategy Stack

Teams of 4 • 7 minutes • Sort, then defend.

1. **Help creditworthy Indians make better financial decisions.**
2. **Become the most trusted financial membership for India's affluent.**
3. **Use CRED's member base to build personalized financial products**
4. **Launch an AI financial coach.**
5. **Build the credit-insight engine and payment reminder flow.**

YOUR OUTPUT

VISION

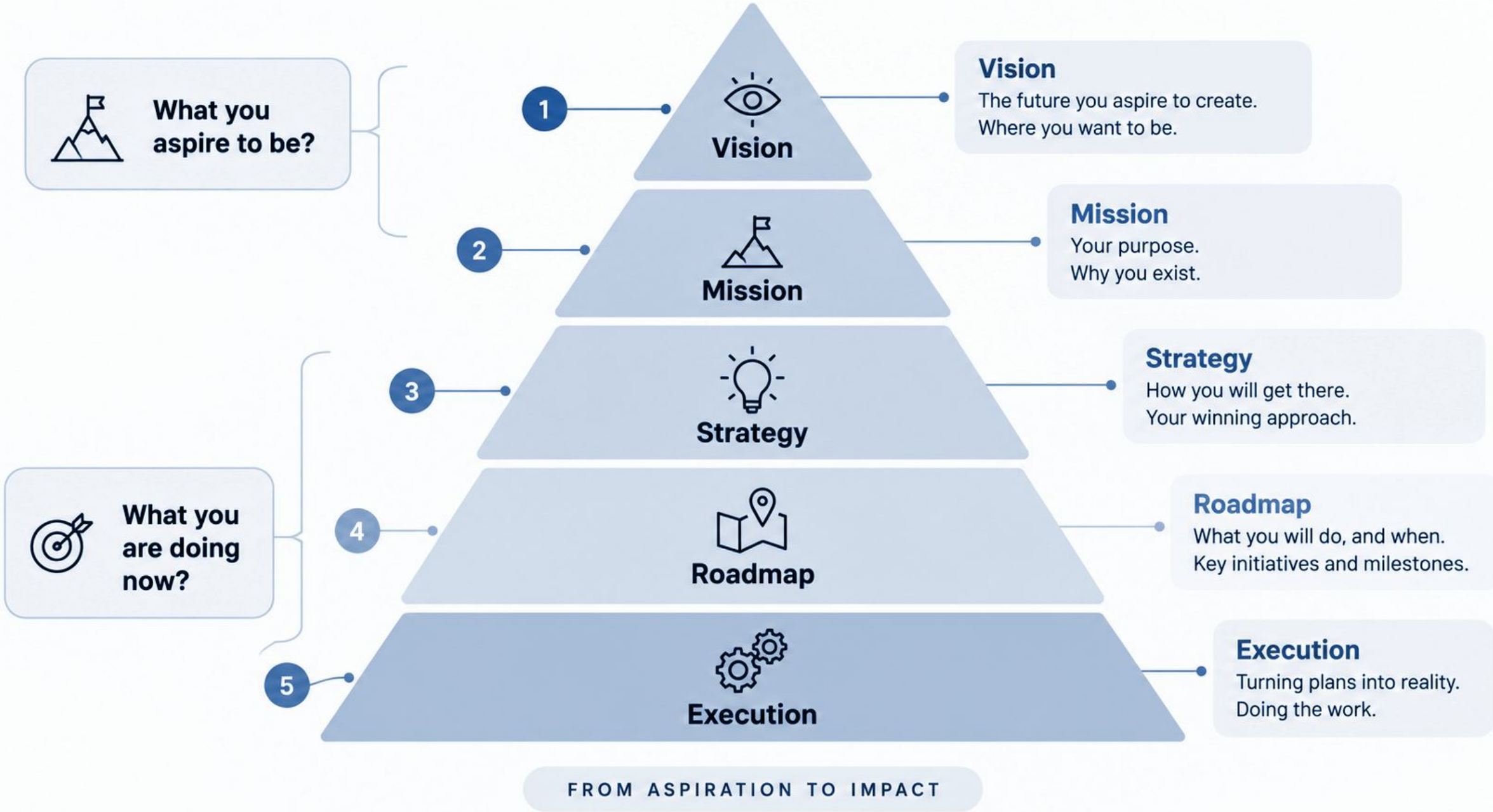
MISSION

STRATEGY

ROADMAP

EXECUTION

Rule: explain WHY.


What you aspire to be?
1
Vision
Vision
The future you aspire to create.
Where you want to be.
2
Mission
Mission
Your purpose.
Why you exist.
3
Strategy
Strategy
How you will get there.
Your winning approach.
What you are doing now?
4
Roadmap
Roadmap
What you will do, and when.
Key initiatives and milestones.
5
Execution
Execution
Turning plans into reality.
Doing the work.
FROM ASPIRATION TO IMPACT

CONCEPT

Strategy connects Vision → Tactics

Strategy is the bridge between aspiration and specific features.

VISION

The WHY.
The dream.
The north star.

Changes rarely.

STRATEGY

How we realize the vision.

Choices + trade-offs.

Changes over months.

TACTICS

Specific features.

What gets built.

Changes over weeks.

VISION = WHERE STRATEGY = HOW TACTICS = WHAT

CONCEPT

What Product Strategy is — and isn't

Keep the distinction sharp.

IT IS

A high-level plan for how goals are achieved.

It defines the product, target users, value creation, monetization and the choices connecting them.

It is a living system that learns and improves.

IT IS NOT

Just a roadmap with dates.

Just goals + actions.

A fixed prediction of what happens in 5–10 years.

A wishlist of features.

CONCEPT

Vision vs Mission

Two different jobs.

VISION

Aspirational
Abstract
Emotional
Long-horizon

What do we aspire to become?

MISSION

Customer-centered
Tangible
Achievable
Quantifiable

What future state do we create for customers?

Great mission statements are inspiring, focused, practical and pervasive.

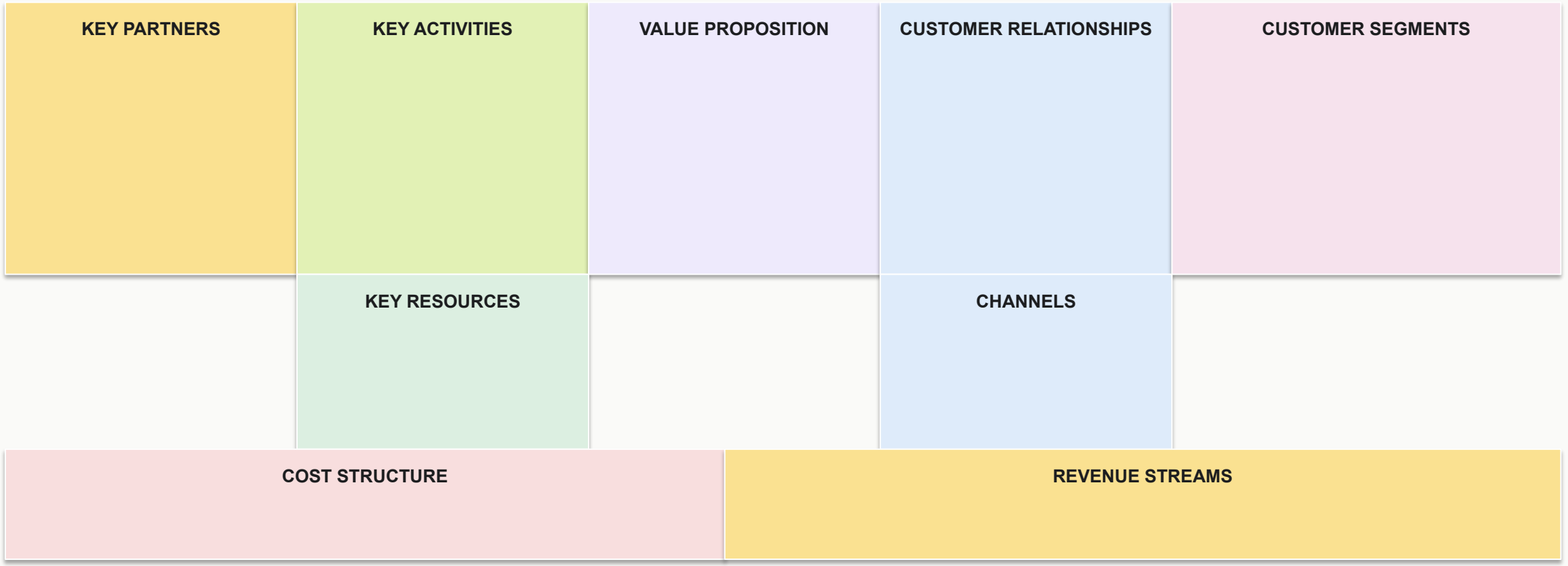
Product Strategy



CONCEPT

Business Model Canvas

Use the canvas to pressure-test the business model.



For today's strategy: WHO creates value? WHO captures value? WHAT enables capture?

The Business Model Canvas – CRED

Pay. Be Responsible. Get Rewarded.

Designed for:	Designed by:	Date:	Version:
CRED	Product Strategy	Sep 2025	1.0

Key Partnerships

- **Banks & card issuers** (e.g., HDFC, SBI, ICICI, Axis)
- **Merchants and brands** (rewards, lifestyle, travel, e-commerce)
- **Payment networks** (Visa, Mastercard, RuPay)
- **NBFCs / lenders** (for credit products)
- **Credit bureaus** (e.g., CIBIL, Experian, Equifax)
- **Financial service providers** (insurance, wealth, investments)

Key Activities

- **Credit card bill payments** (seamless, reliable, secure)
- **Rewards and CRED Coins** (curation and redemption)
- **Member acquisition & engagement** (community, content, campaigns)
- **Credit/financial product distribution** (loans, insurance, etc.)
- **Underwriting & data-driven personalization** (risk, offers, insights)
- **Merchant partnerships** (exclusive deals and experiences)

Key Resources

- **High-creditworthy member base** (trusted, affluent users)
- **Transaction & payment data** (with consent)
- **CRED brand** (premium, trusted, desirable)
- **App / platform** (product, design, user experience)
- **Rewards ecosystem** (brands, merchants, experiences)
- **Technology & data capabilities** (engineering, risk, ML/AI)

Value Propositions

- **Premium rewards for responsible credit behavior** (CRED Coins, exclusive offers)
- **Seamless credit card bill payment experience** (simple, fast, secure)
- **Exclusive brand experiences and curated offers** (lifestyle, travel, entertainment)
- **Access to financial products** (credit, insurance, wealth)
- **Improved visibility and control over credit and payments** (insights, reminders, better financial habits)

Customer Relationships

- **Membership and community** (invite-only, aspirational)
- **Personalized offers and rewards** (based on behavior and preferences)
- **App-led self-service** (intuitive and seamless)
- **Trust and premium experience** (design, privacy, security)
- **Customer support** (in-app help, responsive service)

Channels

- **CRED mobile app** (primary channel)
- **Push notifications / email** (engagement and offers)
- **Social media** (brand building and campaigns)
- **Brand partnerships** (co-marketing, exclusive drops)
- **Member referrals** (organic growth)
- **Events / experiences** (virtual and offline)

Customer Segments

- **Affluent / high-credit-score credit card users** (primary consumer segment)
- **Digitally savvy urban professionals** (tech-first, convenience seeking)
- **Premium consumers** (lifestyle, travel, luxury, experiences)
- **Merchants / brands** (seeking access to affluent, high-intent customers)
- **Financial partners** (banks, NBFCs, insurers, wealth providers seeking creditworthy customers)

Cost Structure

- **Technology and cloud infrastructure** (product development, data, security)
- **Rewards and merchant incentives** (CRED Coins, offers, experiences)
- **Customer acquisition and marketing** (brand, campaigns, partnerships)
- **Payment and operational costs** (transaction processing, platform operations)
- **Employee costs** (engineering, product, design, operations, G&A)
- **Compliance and financial infrastructure** (regulatory, risk, legal, data compliance)

Revenue Streams

- **Commissions / fees from financial product distribution** (loans, credit cards, insurance, wealth products)
- **Merchant / brand partnerships and advertising** (sponsored offers, brand campaigns, exclusive drops)
- **Lending / financial services economics** (interest income, fees via partners / NBFCs)
- **Transaction / payment-related revenue** (e.g., convenience fees, payment services)
- **Premium ecosystem partnerships** (curated experiences, co-branded offerings)

Hypothesis-based canvas: validate with customer and business data.

CRED – For a more rewarding financial life.

CONCEPT

Competitive Strategy

Don't ask only “Who are our competitors?” Ask “Who should we fear?”

PHONEPE

distribution + payments

GOOGLE PAY

habit + simplicity

PAYTM

breadth + financial services

ONECARD

premium credit experience

CRED'S QUESTIONS

What can they do better than CRED?
What can CRED do that they can't?
What can CRED uniquely own?

CONCEPT

Strategic Bets

Strategy becomes actionable when it creates explicit investment choices.

AI FINANCIAL COACH

personalized guidance

WEALTH

asset visibility + investing

PREMIUM UPI

payments + rewards

CREDIT

borrow + improve credit

INSURANCE

protect the member

LIFESTYLE

access + experiences

The question is not “Which ideas are good?”

Which few bets deserve concentrated resources?

CONCEPT

Roadmaps: from Strategy to Execution

A roadmap is a translation layer, not a feature dump.

THEME

Strategic direction

“Make financial management effortless”

EPIC

Outcome-sized body of work

“Unified financial health”

STORY

User-level slice

“See all card dues in one place”

TASK

Concrete build work

“Create aggregation API”

THEME → EPIC → STORY → TASK

ACTIVITY

Market Shock 🚨

Strategy is not a static five-year prediction.

PHONEPE LAUNCHES

A premium financial membership for affluent users.

Same target customer.
Strong payments distribution.
Large marketing budget.

YOU HAVE 90 SECONDS

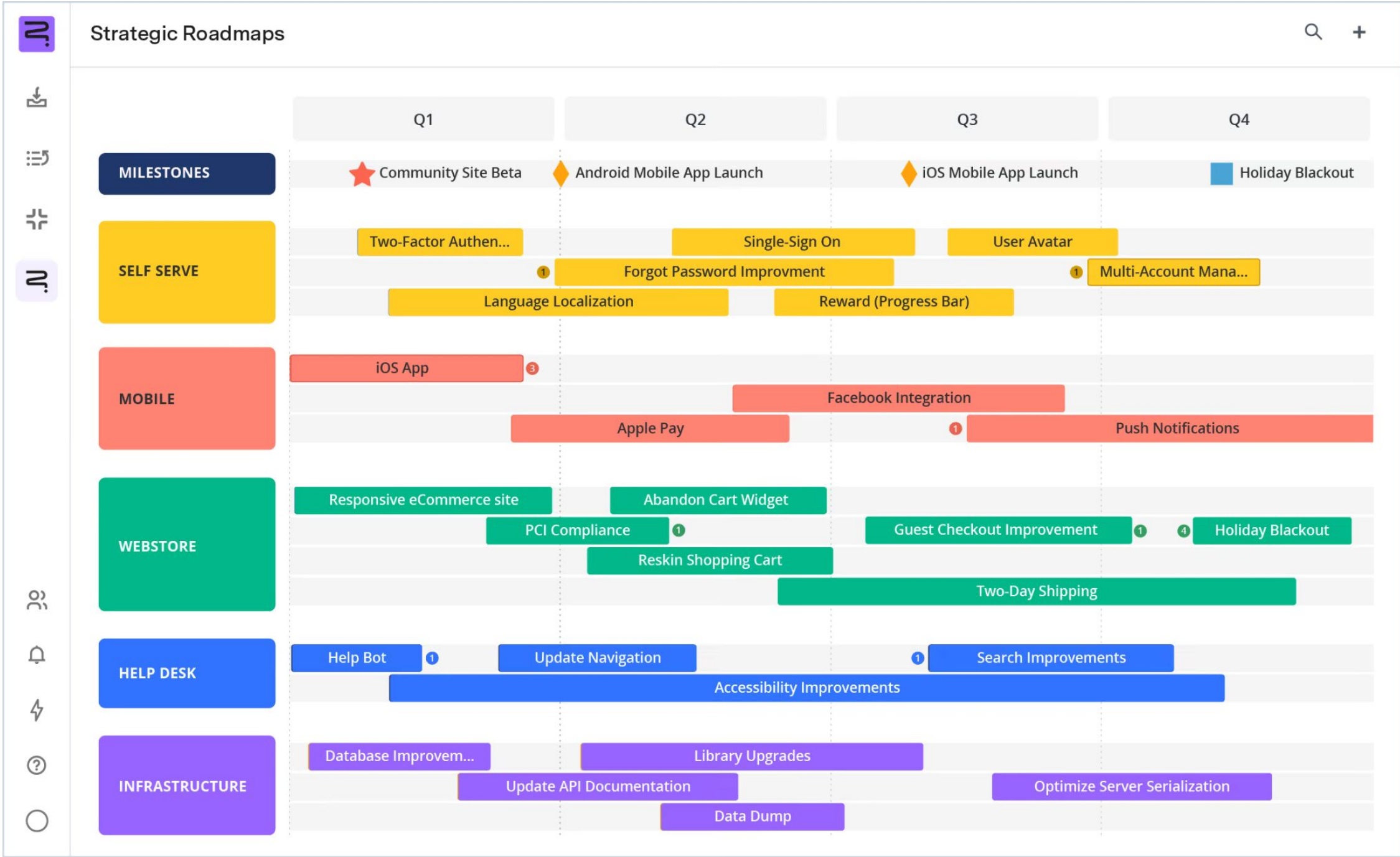
Change ONE thing in your strategy or roadmap.

Explain:
- What changed?
- What stays the same?
- Why?

A living strategy learns, adapts and improves.

Roadmap


Wishlist
Theme
As a customer, I want to be able to have wishlists so that I can come back to buy products later
Epic
As a customer, I want to be able to save a product in my wishlist so that I can view it again later
As a customer, I want to be able to view my wishlist so that I can buy items from it
Stories
Put 'Add to wishlist' button on each product page
Create new db to store wishlist items
Create page to display user's wishlist
Add 'View wishlist' link to homepage
Tasks


Strategic Roadmaps
Q1
Q2
Q3
Q4
MILESTONES
Community Site Beta
Android Mobile App Launch
iOS Mobile App Launch
Holiday Blackout
SELF SERVE
Two-Factor Authen...
Single-Sign On
User Avatar
Forgot Password Improvment
Multi-Account Mana...
Language Localization
Reward (Progress Bar)
MOBILE
iOS App
Facebook Integration
Apple Pay
Push Notifications
WEBSTORE
Responsive eCommerce site
Abandon Cart Widget
PCI Compliance
Guest Checkout Improvement
Holiday Blackout
Reskin Shopping Cart
Two-Day Shipping
HELP DESK
Help Bot
Update Navigation
Search Improvements
Accessibility Improvements
INFRASTRUCTURE
Database Improvem...
Library Upgrades
Update API Documentation
Optimize Server Serialization
Data Dump

OUTPUT

CRED Strategy Challenge — final canvas

One page. One strategy. One set of choices.

VISION

What should CRED become?

TARGET

Who are we winning for?

PROBLEM

What valuable problem do we own?

DIFFERENTIATION

Why CRED?

STRATEGIC BETS

What 3 bets?

TRADE-OFF

What will we NOT do?

SUCCESS

What outcome proves we win?

ROADMAP

NOW → NEXT → LATER